

Glossary of Terms

Plain-English definitions for common estate planning words, prepared by Pathway Estate Planning.

Will

A legal document that sets out who should receive your estate and who should manage it after you die.

Executor

The person or people you appoint in your Will to carry out your wishes and administer your estate.

Beneficiary

A person, charity or organisation who receives something from your estate.

Trust

A legal arrangement where assets are held and managed by Trustees for the benefit of others.

Trustee

A person or professional appointed to manage Trust assets responsibly and in line with the Trust terms.

Lasting Power of Attorney

A document that lets you appoint trusted people to make decisions for you if you cannot make them yourself.

Probate

The legal and administrative process of dealing with someone's estate after they have died.

Inheritance Tax

A tax that may apply to an estate depending on its value, available allowances, reliefs and exemptions.

Rules of Intestacy

The legal rules that decide who inherits if someone dies without a valid Will.
